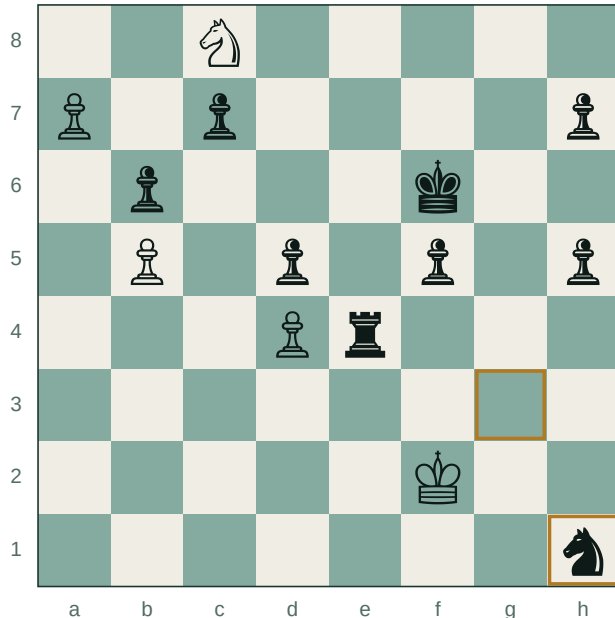


Active defensive resources: White, move 55

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 54...Nh1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55. Kf3 Ng3 56. a8=Q

55.Kf3 The king moves from f2 to f3. Recorded reply: **55...Ng3**.

56.a8=Q The pawn moves from a7 to a8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -8 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on f6. Geometrically undefended: knight on h1. Check for tactical protection.